

of experts, which helped generate a list of the top 10 colleges in the bigger cities instead of just five colleges as was done last year.

To determine the overall ranking, only colleges that figured in the top 50 in arts, science and commerce streams and top 25 for the engineering, medicine and law streams were contacted for factual data. The

colleges that did not provide factual data were not considered in the final ranking process. All the factual information related to a college was rescaled and then aggregated to get an overall factual score. To calculate the overall score, a 70:30 weightage was then assigned to perceptual and factual scores, respectively,—the rationale being the establishment of

consistency with the previous year's study. This methodology of ranking, based on both perceptual and factual data, provides a comprehensive picture of each college rated. The AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG team for the survey comprised Chandana Banerjee, Ram Mohan Dhara, Deep Chowdhury, Maria Rani Tirkey, Neha Yadav, Naveen Wadhwa and Sateesh Nair. ■

THE METHODOLOGY: A COMPARISON

2007
2008

Step 1

OLD Experts across streams were interviewed to strengthen the definitions of the parameters on which colleges are judged. The seven parameters used were—reputation of the college, quality of input, student care, infrastructure, job placements, curriculum and admission procedures.

NEW Interviews were conducted with experts to ratify the parameters on which colleges are judged. Two parameters were dropped from last year—curriculum and admission procedures, as it was identified that colleges did not have much control over these factors.

Step 2

OLD A list was prepared of more than 1,400 colleges in the streams of arts, commerce, science, engineering, medicine and law using secondary sources such as databases, Internet and assorted published material.

NEW A similar procedure was followed this year in preparing the initial list of colleges. If the experts (principals, deans, heads of departments) evaluating the colleges wanted any institution included in the list for ratings, it was added.

Step 3

OLD 360 experts across six streams from 12 cities were shown a list of all the colleges in their field in India. Experts then had to rate the colleges on the seven parameters. Based on the scores in this round, a truncated list of colleges was developed to be shown to experts in the next round.

NEW 400 experts across six streams from 12 cities were shown the list of colleges only in their city—and in their zones for engineering, medicine and law—and were asked to rate them, excluding their own, on the parameters. A national list of 468 colleges was drawn using scores obtained.

Step 4

OLD Based on the pruned-down list of colleges, 540 experts across the six streams from 12 cities were asked to rate the colleges on the basis of the seven identified parameters. Based on the perceptual scores obtained, 225 top colleges across streams were selected to be nationally ranked in the next round.

NEW The national list of colleges was shown to 400 other experts, taking their perceptual rating of these colleges nationally. Based on the perceptual scores obtained, 225 colleges across streams were selected to be nationally ranked. Experts were also shown the list of colleges in their city to obtain city-wise rankings.

Step 5

OLD Factual information was collected from the 225 short-listed colleges on their infrastructure, placements, student calibre and faculty.

NEW The factors on which details were gathered remained the same. Colleges that did not provide data were not considered for the final ranking.

Step 6

OLD To get the overall score for a college, a weightage of 70:30 was applied to the perceptual and factual scores, respectively.

NEW Identical weightages were applied. Apart from the national rankings, top 10 colleges in six metros, instead of the top five, were ranked.